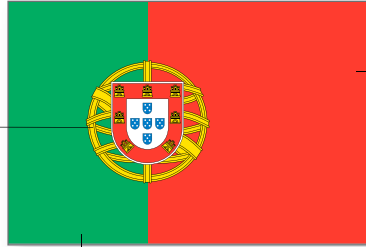


Portugal

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** June 30, 1911 **Usage:** National and Civil

The armillary sphere—an early navigational tool



Red represents revolution

Green represents a Portuguese explorer; King Henry the Navigator

Europe



During the 15th and 16th centuries, **Portugal** played a leading role in discovering the world beyond Europe. It formed a republic in 1910.

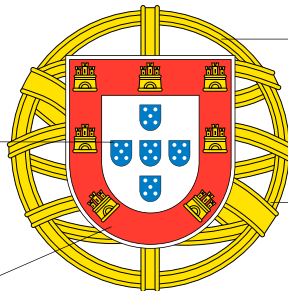
The present flag with red for revolution and green for Portuguese exploration dates from 1910. The central emblem is an armillary sphere, an early navigational instrument, on which is the former royal arms of Portugal. The white

shield was first used by King Sancho I. The five blue shields recall the victory of King Afonso Henriques over five Muslim princes. The red edge and castles are from the marriage of King Alfonso III to a Spanish princess in 1252.

EMBLEM OF PORTUGAL

Five blue shields recall the victory of King Afonso Henriques

Gold castles on red recall the marriage of King Alfonso III to a Spanish Princess



This armillary sphere and shields appear in the center of the Portuguese coat of arms

The armillary sphere recalls the importance of Portuguese exploration of the globe